

Five-Spice Braised Pork Belly

Serves 6 | Main | Prep 20 min | Cook 90 min

INGREDIENTS

1200g Pork belly, skin-on / 30mL Neutral oil / 40g Rock sugar / 3 count Star anise / 1 count Cinnamon stick / 30g Fresh ginger, sliced / 20g Garlic, smashed / 80mL Soy sauce / 20mL Dark soy sauce / 1000mL Water / 30g Scallions, chopped / 3 g Five-spice powder / 450 g Uncooked white rice / 600 mL Water for rice / 600 g Baby bok choy

METHOD

1. Cut pork belly into 4cm cubes. Blanch in boiling water for 3 minutes, drain, and pat dry.
2. Heat oil in a heavy-bottomed pot over medium heat. Add rock sugar and stir until melted and amber-colored.
3. Add pork to the pot, coating well with the sugar syrup. Add ginger, garlic, star anise, and cinnamon. Stir in the five-spice powder.
4. Stir in soy sauce and dark soy sauce. Pour in water until the meat is just covered.
5. Bring to a boil, then cover and reduce heat to low. Simmer for 75-80 minutes until the meat is fork-tender. Meanwhile, cook the rice with its measured water, following the package ratio; steam the washed bok choy for 5-7 minutes just before serving.
6. Remove the lid and increase heat to medium-high to reduce the sauce until thick and glossy, about 10 minutes.
7. Check internal temperature reaches 160°F/71°C. Remove spices.
8. Serve in six bowls garnished with scallions. Divide the rice and bok choy among the six bowls alongside the pork.

KITCHEN NOTE

Best served with steamed bok choy to balance the richness. Developed for Real Family. Not kitchen-tested.

ALLERGENS

Soy. Check every product label.

STORAGE & LEFTOVERS

Refrigerate in an airtight container within 2 hours; consume within 3 days. Reheat to 165°F/74°C.

Wash produce, avoid cross-contamination, refrigerate leftovers promptly. Poultry: 165°F / 74°C; fish: 145°F / 63°C.